

CRISIS ACTION

ACTION-01

FORENSIC ANALYSIS

CATEGORY: Investigation

COST: 12 Budget

INVESTIGATION ADVANCE: +25%

DURATION: 2 turns (multi-turn action)

DESCRIPTION

Forensic experts analyze compromised systems to determine: What data was accessed; What was exfiltrated; How long attacker had access; What attack techniques were used; Evidence for legal proceedings;

KEY DETAILS

Requires shutting down compromised system (removes it from operation); Requires forensics team (may need external consultants); Takes time (2 turns minimum); Provides detailed evidence; Essential for legal action and regulatory compliance;

WHEN TO USE

Need definitive answer about breach scope; Legal action is likely; Compliance investigation required; Regulatory agency involved;

RISK IF NOT DONE

Cannot determine full extent of damage; Cannot properly remediate (may miss persistence); No evidence for law enforcement; Regulatory penalties for inadequate investigation;

REGULATORY IMPACT

Most breach notification laws require "reasonable investigation"; Forensics evidence may be required for regulatory compliance; Better investigation = stronger regulatory defense;

TEAM TRADE-OFF

Expensive (12 Budget); Takes time (2 turns); But provides high investigation %; Provides evidence for future action;

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CRISIS ACTION

ACTION-02

THREAT HUNTING

CATEGORY: Investigation

COST: 8 Budget

INVESTIGATION ADVANCE: +15%

DURATION: 1 turn

DESCRIPTION

Security team proactively searches logs and systems for: Other compromised systems; Lateral movement indicators; Persistence mechanisms; Command & Control communication; Evidence of data staging;

KEY DETAILS

Requires SIEM with good logging (if available); Team searches for attack indicators; Can discover secondary compromises; Lower cost than forensics but less detailed; Faster than forensics (1 turn);

WHEN TO USE

Need to know if compromise spread; Want to find hidden persistence; Time is critical (forensics takes 2 turns); Budget is constrained;

RISK IF NOT DONE

May not discover all compromised systems; Attacker may maintain hidden access; May lose evidence over time (logs rotate); Compliance investigation may be incomplete;

REGULATORY IMPACT

Shows good faith investigation effort; Supports "reasonable investigation" standard; Evidence of proactive security posture;

TEAM TRADE-OFF

Cheaper than forensics (8 Budget); Faster (1 turn vs. 2); Less detailed evidence; Good balance of cost/time/effectiveness;

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CRISIS ACTION

ACTION-03

LOG ANALYSIS

CATEGORY: Investigation

COST: 9 Budget

INVESTIGATION ADVANCE: +10%

DURATION: 1 turn

DESCRIPTION

Security team reviews available logs (firewall, VPN, Windows Event Log, application logs) to understand: When breach was discovered; What access was gained; What systems were accessed; What data might have been accessed; Timeline of attack;

KEY DETAILS

Requires logs (must have been collecting logs); Basic analysis of existing logs; Cheapest investigation action; Quick (1 turn); Limited by log retention/quality; Can be done internally (no external consultants);

WHEN TO USE

Budget is extremely tight; Need quick preliminary understanding; Good logging infrastructure in place; Time is critical;

RISK IF NOT DONE

No understanding of what happened; Cannot determine scope or impact; Regulatory agencies upset about lack of investigation; Potential for incomplete response;

REGULATORY IMPACT

Minimal investigation (may not satisfy "reasonable investigation"); Shows attempt at investigation; Not sufficient as sole investigation method;

TEAM TRADE-OFF

Cheapest investigation (5 Budget); Fastest (1 turn); Limited effectiveness; Often insufficient alone;

INCIDENT ZERO - DISASTER RECOVERY

CRISIS ACTION

ACTION-04

THIRD-PARTY INCIDENT RESPONSE ENGAGEMENT

CATEGORY: Investigation (+ Remediation)

COST: 20 Budget

INVESTIGATION ADVANCE: +30% (+ Remediation +20%)

DURATION: 3 turns (ongoing engagement)

DESCRIPTION

Bring in external incident response firm (forensics, incident handling, remediation specialists). They conduct: Comprehensive forensic investigation; Breach scope determination; Remediation recommendations; Expert testimony for legal proceedings; Regulatory coordination;

KEY DETAILS

Very expensive (20 Budget); Takes significant time to mobilize; Provides expert guidance and credibility; Provides evidence acceptable in court; Supports regulatory defense; Multi-turn (Duration 3): occupies your action slot only on the turn started; see Multi-Turn Actions rule;

WHEN TO USE

Major breach with legal implications; Need expert investigation for court; Regulatory agency demands expertise; Internal team cannot handle scope; Liability is significant;

BENEFITS

Expert investigation (higher quality); Evidence for prosecution; Regulatory/legal credibility; Expert testimony available; Ongoing support (3 turns);

RISK IF NOT DONE

Without external expertise, breach response may be insufficient; Legal case may fail (poor evidence); Regulatory penalties for inadequate investigation; May miss critical evidence;

REGULATORY IMPACT

High credibility with regulators; Better legal defense; Shows serious investigation effort; External experts satisfy "reasonable investigation";

TEAM TRADE-OFF

Most expensive (20 Budget); Long commitment (Duration 3 - advances apply at the start of the 3rd following turn); But provides significant investigation + remediation; Provides external expertise and credibility; While in flight you may take single-turn actions, but no other multi-turn action (v2.2 Multi-Turn rule);

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CRISIS ACTION

ACTION-05

PATCH & HARDEN (AFFECTED SYSTEMS)

CATEGORY: Remediation

COST: 10 Budget

REMEDIATION ADVANCE: +20%

DURATION: 1 turn

DESCRIPTION

Apply patches to the vulnerability that was exploited; Install OS patches (if vulnerability is OS-level); Update application (if vulnerability is app-level); Change default credentials; Remove backdoor accounts; Harden network configuration;

KEY DETAILS

Targets the specific vulnerability that was exploited; Must know what vulnerability was exploited (requires investigation); Can be done on specific systems or organization-wide; Prevents same attack from succeeding again; Does NOT remove attacker if already inside;

WHEN TO USE

Know what vulnerability was exploited; Want to prevent re-exploitation; Can apply patch without affecting business; Quick remediation needed;

RISK IF NOT DONE

Attacker can re-exploit same vulnerability; Breach scope may grow; Regulatory agency upset about lack of remediation; Risk of breach happening again;

REGULATORY IMPACT

Shows timely remediation; Prevents recurrence; Good compliance posture; Regulatory agencies expect patching;

TEAM TRADE-OFF

Moderate cost (10 Budget); Quick (1 turn); Fixes vulnerability; But only prevents re-exploitation, doesn't remove attacker;

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CRISIS ACTION

ACTION-06

CONTAINMENT (ISOLATE COMPROMISED SYSTEMS)

CATEGORY: Remediation

COST: 8 Budget

REMEDIATION ADVANCE: +15%

DURATION: 1 turn

DESCRIPTION

Remove compromised systems from network to: Stop attacker from using compromised system for lateral movement; Prevent attacker from exfiltrating more data; Preserve compromised system for forensics; Limit blast radius of compromise;

KEY DETAILS

Disconnect compromised system from network (kill network); System is still available for forensics; Stops active attacker in that system; Does NOT affect attacker if they're in other systems; May impact business (systems are unavailable);

WHEN TO USE

Know which systems are compromised; Want to stop active attacker; Can tolerate system downtime; Attacker is still actively in system;

RISK IF NOT DONE

Attacker continues using compromised system; Lateral movement continues; More data exfiltration; Attacker may install additional backdoors;

REGULATORY IMPACT

Shows swift containment action; Demonstrates incident response; Limits liability (stopped attacker); Good compliance posture;

TEAM TRADE-OFF

Moderate cost (8 Budget); Quick (1 turn); Stops active attacker; But impacts business operations;

INCIDENT ZERO - DISASTER RECOVERY

CRISIS ACTION

ACTION-07

SYSTEM REBUILD/RECOVERY FROM BACKUP

CATEGORY: Remediation

COST: 15 Budget

REMEDIATION ADVANCE: +25%

DURATION: 2 turns (restore + verification)

DESCRIPTION

Rebuild compromised systems from backup; Restore system from clean backup (pre-compromise); Apply patches to prevent re-exploitation; Restore only clean data; Verify system is clean before returning to production; Monitor restored system for attacker re-entry;

KEY DETAILS

Requires backup of system (must exist and be clean); Takes time to restore (2 turns minimum); Removes all attacker artifacts; Ensures system is truly clean; Most reliable remediation method; Dependent on backup quality/testing;

WHEN TO USE

Backup exists and is verified clean; System compromise is extensive; Want to ensure complete attacker removal; Business can tolerate 2-turn rebuild;

RISK IF NOT DONE

Attacker may maintain persistence (if system not rebuilt); Restore from backup with attacker in it = no improvement; Compliance may require clean rebuild;

REGULATORY IMPACT

Shows complete remediation; Demonstrates thorough approach; Better regulatory outcome; Shows commitment to clean recovery;

TEAM TRADE-OFF

Higher cost (15 Budget); Takes time (2 turns); But provides complete remediation; Most reliable method;

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CRISIS ACTION

ACTION-08

CHANGE CREDENTIALS & ACCESS CONTROLS

CATEGORY: Remediation

COST: 6 Budget

REMEDIATION ADVANCE: +12%

DURATION: 1 turn

DESCRIPTION

Revoke and reset all potentially compromised credentials: Reset passwords for all accounts that touched compromised system; Revoke tokens/API keys; Reset VPN credentials; Update database passwords; Revoke certificates/SSH keys;

KEY DETAILS

Prevents attacker from using stolen credentials; Must do if credentials were compromised (stolen by Minikatz, etc.); Can cause business disruption (users locked out); Quick and important; Often overlooked but critical;

WHEN TO USE

Credentials were likely compromised; Attacker had access to credential stores; Need to prevent attacker re-entry via stolen credentials; Quick credential reset is possible;

RISK IF NOT DONE

Attacker can use stolen credentials to re-enter; Lateral movement using stolen creds continues; Breach is not truly contained; Regulatory violation (allowing unauthorized access);

REGULATORY IMPACT

Regulatory remediation step; Shows understanding of attack chain; Prevents credential reuse attacks; Regulatory expectation;

TEAM TRADE-OFF

Low cost (6 Budget); Quick (1 turn); Important and often overlooked; Can cause short-term business disruption;

INCIDENT ZERO - DISASTER RECOVERY

CRISIS ACTION

ACTION-09

CUSTOMER NOTIFICATION

CATEGORY: Communication

COST: 10 Budget

COMMUNICATION ADVANCE: +20%

DURATION: 1 turn (but affects later turns)

DEADLINE (V9.2): Recommended by end of "Turn 8". If not completed by then: Customer trust -10 at the start of each later turn; if never completed in-game: -15 Reputation at final scoring (deferred statutory violation).

DESCRIPTION

Notify customers that their data may have been breached; Determine which customers were affected; Prepare notification message; Send via email, mail, or phone; Provide information about what was accessed; Offer credit monitoring/identity protection if applicable; Field customer questions/complaints;

KEY DETAILS

Required by breach notification laws ("without unreasonable delay" in California and most U.S. states; GDPR requires notifying individuals without undue delay when risk is high); Can be very expensive if many customers affected; Notification can cause loss of customer trust; Early notification shows good faith; Delayed notification shows company doesn't care; Impacts customers stakeholder directly;

REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS

Most laws require notification "without unreasonable delay"; some states set specific outer limits; California: notify without unreasonable delay; CCPA: statutory damages fuel class actions; Notification must include: What information was accessed; Recommended actions; Contact information; Free credit monitoring (sometimes);

WHEN TO USE

Customer data was accessed in breach; Regulatory requirement to notify; Want to rebuild customer trust; Transparency is important;

RISK IF NOT DONE

Regulatory violation (fines, penalties); Customer discovery + lawsuits; Loss of customer trust (worse than notification); Reputation damage from cover-up worse than from breach;

CONTINUED IN MODULE 8 RULES

INCIDENT ZERO - DISASTER RECOVERY



CRISIS ACTION

ACTION-10

REGULATORY/LAW ENFORCEMENT NOTIFICATION

CATEGORY: Communication

COST: 8 Budget

COMMUNICATION ADVANCE: +104

DURATION: 1 turn (but ongoing for months)

DEADLINE (V2.2): Must be completed by end of "Turn 8" (the GDPR 72-hour anchor). Escalating penalty: from Turn 6; if not yet completed, Regulator trust -10 at the start of Turns 6, 7, and 8. If never completed in-game: -20 Reputation at final scoring (deferred fine).

DESCRIPTION

Notify appropriate regulatory agencies: Contact FBI/Secret Service (federal crimes); Contact state attorney general (breach notification); Contact relevant sector regulator (HHS for healthcare, OCC for banking, etc.); Contact DHS (if critical infrastructure); Coordinate with law enforcement;

KEY DETAILS

Required by law in many cases (healthcare, financial, etc.); May trigger investigation by law enforcement; Can help recover stolen data; Provides some legal protection; can delay prosecution (if they're investigating); Required before public disclosure in some cases;

REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS

EU data (GDPR): Must notify the supervisory authority within 72 hours; fines up to €20M or 4% of global turnover, whichever is HIGHER (narrative-only figure); Healthcare (HIPAA): Must report to HHS Office for Civil Rights; Financial (GLBA/FFIEC): Must report to banking regulators; Payment cards (PCI-DSS): Must report to card networks; Critical infrastructure: Must report to DHS/CISA;

WHEN TO USE

Data breach triggers regulatory requirement; Want law enforcement assistance; Want to establish good faith investigation; Legal team recommends it;

RISK IF NOT DONE

Regulatory violation if required; Law enforcement cannot assist; Company appears to be hiding breach; Regulators may impose penalties;

REGULATORY IMPACT

Required in many cases (legal obligation); Shows cooperation with authorities; May help recover stolen data; Better regulatory relationship; May reduce penalties (see Regulatory Cards)

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CRISIS ACTION

ACTION-13

RANSOM DECISION (V2.2)

CATEGORY: Crisis Decision

COST: Varies by option (see below)

TIMING: Play at any time before the ransom deadline (default: start of Turn 5). Playing this card does NOT use your turn's action slot – it is a decision made in addition to your normal action. Once per game. If no decision is made by the deadline, the team is treated as having chosen REFUSE.

DATA-PUBLICATION EVENT (REFERENCE): In ransom scenarios, if the team has not PAID by the ransom deadline (default: start of Turn 5) +2 turns if NEGOTIATE), the attacker publishes stolen data: Customer trust -20, Media trust -15 (and the REFUSE scoring penalty above, if applicable).

EDUCATIONAL PURPOSE: There is no "right" answer – payment is a genuine trade-off between operational recovery, ethics, legality, and reputation.

Used only in scenarios with a ransom/extortion demand. Choose exactly ONE option: Option A – PAY – Cost: 20 Budget (~ \$1M at 1 Budget ~ \$50K) – Reputation: -15 at final scoring – Effect: The data-publication event is skipped/cancelled. +20% Remediation immediately (decryption keys restore systems). – No guarantee: The Threat Orchestrator rolls a d20. On 1-5, the keys don't work – no refund, and the Remediation advance is +0% instead of +20%. (The publication event stays cancelled; the attacker took the money and moved on.) – Flavor: "Criminals are not a customer-service organization." Option B – NEGOTIATE – Cost: 5 Budget (negotiator/counsel fees) – Reputation: -5 at final scoring – Effect: The data-publication event is delayed by 2 turns (default: from start of Turn 5 to start of Turn 7). Buys time to notify stakeholders and remediate before publication. Option C – REFUSE – Cost: 0 Budget – Reputation: No immediate change. If the data-publication event triggers later: -20 Reputation at final scoring. – Effect: No payment, no delay. Focus budget on investigation, remediation, and communication.

LEGAL & PRACTICAL FACTS (CORRECTED V2.2)

Payment may violate OFAC sanctions if the threat actor is sanctioned; many insurers restrict or exclude ransom coverage; Law enforcement (FBI) discourages payment – It funds and incentivizes future attacks; Payment does not guarantee data deletion or working keys;

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EVENT CARD

EVENT-03

CUSTOMER NOTIFICATION WINDOW

SCHEDULED: Turn 5

TYPE: Deadline checkpoint

DESCRIPTION

Counsel confirms customer notification should not wait any longer. Real-world laws require notification "without unreasonable delay" – in this game, the recommended deadline is end of Turn 5.

RESOLUTION

If ACTION-09 (Customer Notification) is completed by end of Turn 5: no penalty. If it was framed transparently, +5 Reputation at final scoring.; If not: Customer trust -10 now and at the start of each later turn until ACTION-09 is completed.; Deferred consequence: if customers are never notified in-game, -15 Reputation at final scoring (the statutory notification window is missed after the game ends).;

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CRISIS ACTION

ACTION-11

MEDIA/PUBLIC RELATIONS MANAGEMENT

CATEGORY: Communication

COST: 12 Budget

COMMUNICATION ADVANCE: +154

DURATION: 1 turn (but ongoing for days/weeks)

DESCRIPTION

Manage media coverage and public perception: Prepare press statement; Contact media proactively; Manage social media response; Coordinate CEO/executive messaging; Defend company reputation; Provide accurate information to media;

KEY DETAILS

Can heavily influence public perception; Proactive messaging better than reactive; Media coverage can amplify damage; Poor communication = reputation disaster; Good communication = company "handled it well"; HR firm may be needed (crisis PR);

WHEN TO USE

Breach is significant (likely to attract media); Company has public reputation risk; Customers are media-aware (B2C more than B2B); Proactive messaging is possible;

RISK IF NOT DONE

Media covers story with only attacker's perspective; Reputation damage from poor response; Stock price may drop (if public company); "No comment" looks like company is hiding; Social media amplifies negative coverage;

IMPACT IF DONE WELL

"Company handled breach responsibly"; Trust is maintained or recovered; Stock price less impacted; Reputation damage is contained; Customer retention better; (see Stakeholder Cards); Critical for public companies; Can significantly affect perception;

TEAM TRADE-OFF

Higher cost (12 Budget); Ongoing (multiple turns); Impacts Media/Board stakeholder (see Stakeholder Cards); Critical for public companies; Can significantly affect perception;

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EVENT CARD

EVENT-01

FIRST MEDIA COVERAGE

SCHEDULED: Turn 2

TYPE: Discovery

DURATION: Ongoing narrative (media coverage continues)

DESCRIPTION

A news outlet publishes a story about the breach: "Company Suffers Data Breach" headline; Unnamed source gives details; Story spreads on social media; Phone starts ringing with reporter calls;

RESOLUTION

If ACTION-11 (Media Management) was completed before this turn: Media trust +5 (proactive framing works); Otherwise: Media trust -10 (the story runs without your side);

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EVENT CARD

EVENT-09

SHAREHOLDER PRESSURE

SCHEDULED: Turn 5 (public companies only – skip for private companies)

TYPE: Governance

DESCRIPTION

Shareholder activists contact the board: demand explanations, threaten a proxy fight, and give interviews about leadership failure.

RESOLUTION

If ACTION-12 (Board Communication) has been completed: Board trust -5 (pressure is absorbed); Otherwise: Board trust -15;

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CRISIS ACTION

ACTION-12

BOARD & SHAREHOLDER COMMUNICATION

CATEGORY: Communication

COST: 9 Budget

COMMUNICATION ADVANCE: +124

DURATION: 1 turn (but triggers Board Meeting – see Event Cards)

DESCRIPTION

Inform board of directors and shareholders about breach: Prepare incident briefing for board; Present forensics findings; Discuss regulatory/legal implications; Present remediation plan and costs; Discuss risk mitigation going forward; Field board questions;

KEY DETAILS

Board must be informed promptly; Disclosure may be required (SEC rules if public company); Board has fiduciary duty to inform shareholders; Lawsuit risk if board hides information; Board can fire CEO if response is poor; Must include implications for D&O insurance;

REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS

SEC disclosure rules (if public company); State corporate law (fiduciary duty); Insurance requirements (D&O coverage);

WHEN TO USE

Board needs to understand breach; Public company (SEC disclosure likely needed); Board questions will come (better to be prepared); Shareholder lawsuits are likely;

RISK IF NOT DONE

Board discovers breach from media = crisis of confidence; Shareholder lawsuits for non-disclosure; SEC investigation for disclosure violations; CEO may be fired (looked like hiding information); Stock price crashes when discovered;

IMPACT IF DONE WELL

Board is informed and supportive; No surprise when disclosed; Board can defend company (if sued); Stock market takes news in stride; Organized response is possible;

TEAM TRADE-OFF

Moderate cost (9 Budget); Critical for public companies; Impacts Board stakeholder (see Stakeholder Cards); Required by law (usually); Complete before EVENT-04 (Board Meeting, scheduled Turn 3) to be "prepared" (see Event Cards);

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EVENT CARD

EVENT-04

BOARD MEETING

SCHEDULED: Turn 3

TYPE: Governance

DESCRIPTION

The board of directors holds an emergency meeting to review breach scope, investigation progress, remediation plan, budget, and executive performance.

RESOLUTION

If ACTION-12 (Board Communication) was completed before this turn: Board trust +10 (prepared briefing); Otherwise: Board trust -20 (the board learns details from the news, not from you);

TEAM PREPARATION

Should have forensics/investigation underway; Should have preliminary findings; Should have a communication plan; CEO should be briefed;

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EVENT CARD

EVENT-02

REGULATORY 72-HOUR DEADLINE

SCHEDULED: Turn 6 (escalation begins; final deadline end of Turn 8)

TYPE: Deadline

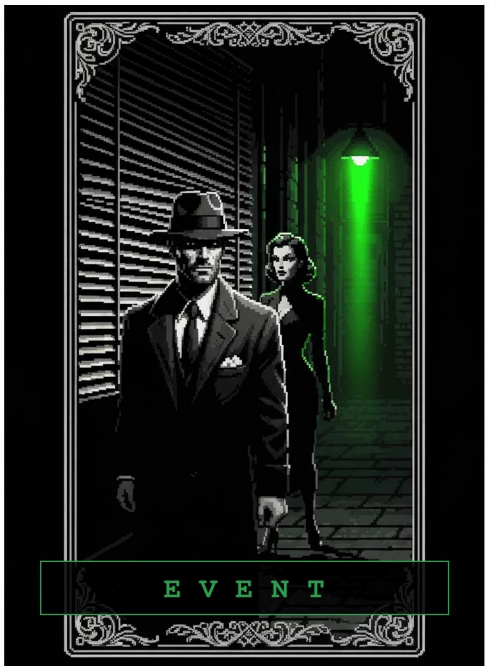
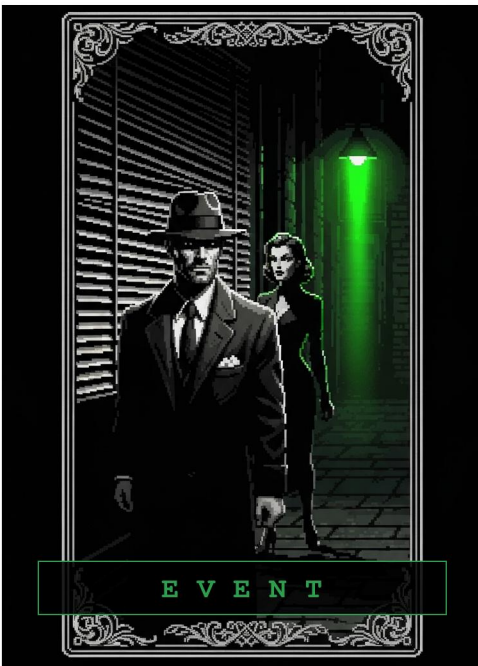
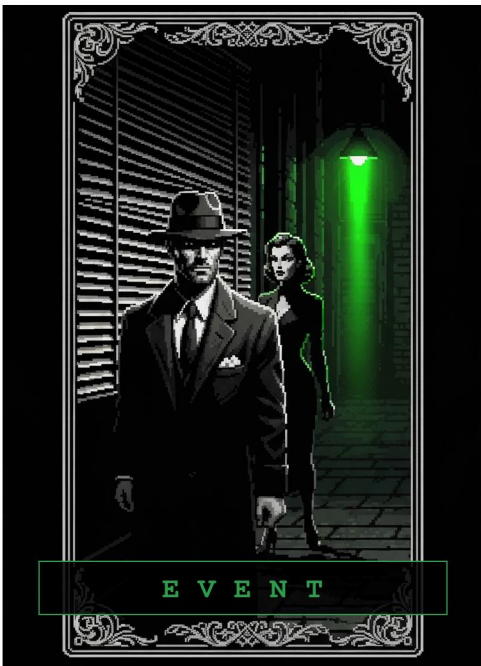
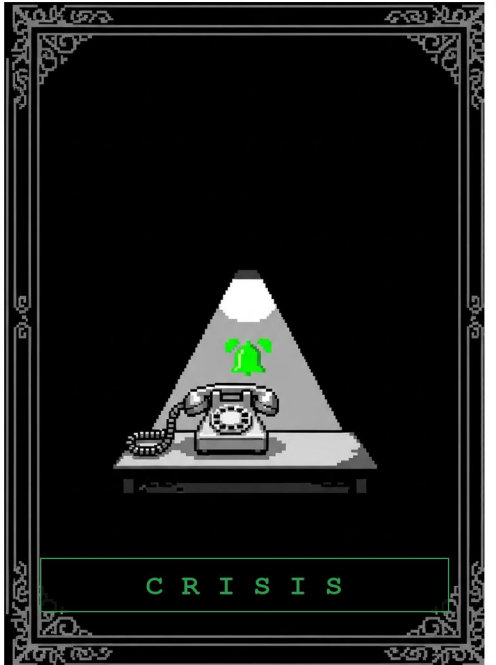
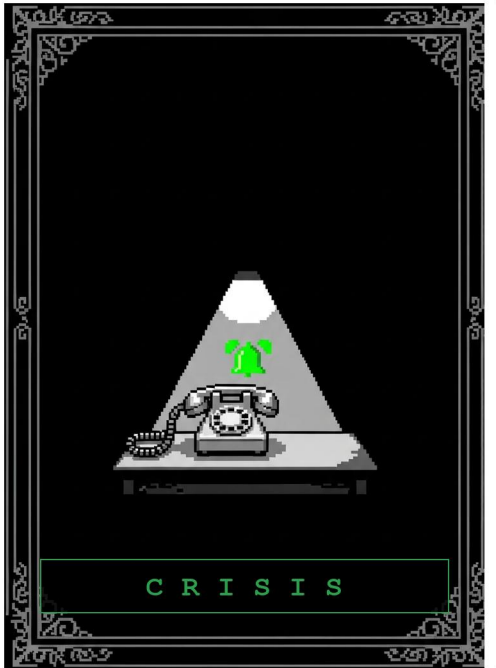
DESCRIPTION

The GDPR-style 72-hour clock is running out. Regulators expect notification of the breach (ACTION-10) before the clock expires at end of Turn 8.

RESOLUTION

If ACTION-10 (Regulatory Notification) is already completed: Regulator trust +5 (early, cooperative notification); If not: Regulator trust -10 now and at the start of each later turn (Turns 6, 7, 8) until ACTION-10 is completed.; Deferred consequence: if regulators are never notified in-game, -20 Reputation at final scoring (deferred fine – GDPR fines run up to €20M or 4% of global turnover, whichever is HIGHER; narrative-only figure).;

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EVENT CARD

EVENT-12

GOVERNMENT SUBPOENA

SCHEDULED: Turn 7 (medium/large breaches – skip for small-scope games)

TYPE: Legal

OPPORTUNITY: an independent investigation can validate a good-faith response; law enforcement may help recover evidence.

DESCRIPTION

A subpoena arrives (FBI, state attorney general, or a congressional inquiry): turn over evidence, provide executive testimony, comply with the investigation.

RESOLUTION

Budget -5 (legal fees; floor 0); Executive trust -10 (executives in the spotlight); Investigation +5% (compelled evidence-sharing accelerates fact-finding);

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EVENT CARD

EVENT-05

CUSTOMER CLASS ACTION LAWSUIT

TRIGGER: ACTION-09 not completed by end of Turn 5, OR Customer trust below 20% at the start of any turn.

TYPE: Legal

TEAM RESPONSE: Cannot be undone – only mitigated by rebuilding trust for the rest of the game.

DESCRIPTION

A law firm recruits customers and files a class action: "Jane Doe et al. vs. [Company Name]" – failure to protect data, failure to notify in a timely way, damages plus attorney fees.

EFFECTS

Customer trust -15; Board trust -10; -10 Reputation at final scoring;

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EVENT CARD

EVENT-06

REGULATORY FINE

TRIGGER: Regulator trust below 20% at the start of any turn. (If regulators are never notified in-game, the deferred -20 Reputation from EVENT-02 applies at scoring instead – do not double-apply.)

TYPE: Regulatory

REAL-WORLD SCALE (NARRATIVE-ONLY): turnover-based regimes drive the largest penalties – GDPR fines can reach €20M or 4% of global turnover, whichever is HIGHER.

DESCRIPTION

A regulator announces a penalty for inadequate security and delayed cooperation.

EFFECTS

Budget -10 (= \$500K; floor 0); Board trust -10; -10 Reputation at final scoring;

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EVENT CARD

EVENT-07

MEDIA FRENZY

TRIGGER: Media trust below 20% at the start of any turn, OR no Communication-category action completed by end of Turn 3.

TYPE: Communication

TEAM RESPONSE: ACTION-11 (Media Management) plus visible, transparent leadership.

DESCRIPTION

Major outlets pick up the story: national coverage, "Massive Data Breach" headlines, social media amplification.

EFFECTS

Media trust -20; Customer trust -15; Board trust -10;

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EVENT CARD

EVENT-08

SECOND BREACH DISCOVERED

TRIGGER: At the start of Turn 6, Remediation is below 30% AND ACTION-07 (Rebuild) has not been completed.

TYPE: Escalation – **once per game**

PREVENTION: ACTION-07 (Rebuild), ACTION-04 (Third-Party IR), or strong Remediation progress by Turn 6.

DESCRIPTION

While responding to the first breach, investigators discover another compromised data store – the attacker maintained hidden persistence.

EFFECTS

The game extends by +2 turns (once per game): play now runs to Turn 10. Scoring deadlines do NOT move – the regulatory deadline remains end of Turn 8.; Investigation -30% (new breach invalidates part of your picture); Customer trust -20, Regulator trust -15, Media trust -10, Board trust -15; Board releases +10 emergency Budget; -10 Reputation at final scoring;

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EVENT CARD

EVENT-10

COMPETITOR ADVANTAGE

TRIGGER: Customer trust below 40% at the start of Turn 5 or any later turn.

TYPE: Business

TEAM RESPONSE: Customer communication and visible security improvements; trust can rebuild over the remaining turns.

DESCRIPTION

A competitor launches a "Trust us with your data" campaign aimed at your customers.

EFFECTS

Customer trust -10; Budget -5 (lost revenue; floor 0);

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EVENT CARD

EVENT-11

KEY EXECUTIVE RESIGNATION

TRIGGER: Executive trust below 30% at the start of any turn.

TYPE: Internal

PREVENTION: Regular internal communication, visible progress, board support.

DESCRIPTION

A key executive (CISO, CTO, General Counsel, or CFO) resigns mid-crisis, citing "personal reasons" – really: "I don't trust this response."

EFFECTS

Executive trust -10; Board trust -10; While Executive trust remains below 30%, the Justification bonus (optional +5% d20) is unavailable – leadership vacuum;

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STAKEHOLDER CARD

STAKE-01

CUSTOMERS

STAKEHOLDER TYPE: External

PRIMARY CONCERN: Data privacy and service availability

TRUST METER: Starts at 50%

DECAY (V2.2): From Turn 3 onward, if the team has completed no Communication-category action (the free Holding Statement counts), Customer trust -10 at the start of each turn. This does not stack with the Turn-5 notification penalty (EVENT-03) – apply one, not both, per turn. Below 20% = CRITICAL warning state (may trigger EVENT-05).

DESCRIPTION

The customers whose data was breached. They want to know: What data was accessed; Whether it was encrypted; What they should do (change password, watch credit!); Whether the company is protecting them; Whether to switch providers;

BEHAVIOR

High Trust (70%+): Continue using service, minor PR impact; Medium Trust (40-70%): Some customer loss, but company is "handling it"; Low Trust (<40%): Customer exodus, lawsuits, regulatory investigation; Critical (<20%): Mass churn, bankruptcy risk, acquisition/collapse;

WHAT AFFECTS TRUST

Increases Trust: Customer Notification (ACTION-09): +15%; Public statement about patch/fix: +5%; Free credit monitoring offer: +10%; Quick response time: +5% per turn if investigating; Decreases Trust: No communication: -10% per turn; Media reports breach before notification: -20%; Delayed response: -5% per turn; Second breach during response: -30%; "No comment" from company: -15%;

GOAL

Ideally maintain above 50% for a positive outcome (trust feeds the final Reputation computation!);

LOSS (V2.2 SINGLE RULE)

Customer trust at 0% = company collapses (immediate loss); Narrative: mass churn, lawsuits, bankruptcy/acquisition;

CRISIS ACTIONS THAT HELP

ACTION-09 (Customer Notification): +15% trust; ACTION-11 (Media Management): +10% trust; Any remediation action that shows progress: +2-5%;

CONTINUED IN MODULE RULES

INCIDENT ZERO · DISASTER RECOVERY

STAKEHOLDER CARD

STAKE-02

REGULATORS

STAKEHOLDER TYPE: Government/legal

PRIMARY CONCERN: Compliance with breach notification laws

TRUST METER: Starts at 60%

ESCALATION (V2.2): If ACTION-10 is not completed, Regulator trust -10 at the start of each turn from Turn 8 (see EVENT-02). Below 20% = CRITICAL warning state (triggers EVENT-04 Regulatory Fine).

DESCRIPTION

Government agencies that regulate data privacy: State attorneys general (breach notification laws); Federal regulators (healthcare, financial, etc.); International regulators (GDPR if any EU customers); Law enforcement (FBI, Secret Service);

BEHAVIOR

High Confidence (70%+): Voluntary cooperation, no penalties; Medium Confidence (40-70%): Investigation, possible fines; Low Confidence (<40%): Aggressive investigation, significant fines; Critical (<20%): Criminal prosecution, company shut down;

WHAT AFFECTS REGULATORY CONFIDENCE

Increases Confidence: Regulatory Notification (ACTION-10): +20%; Prompt customer notification: +10%; Third-party incident response (ACTION-04): +15%; Forensics evidence: +10%; Proactive remediation: +5%; Decreases Confidence: Notification late (Turns 6-8, un-notified): -10% per turn (the single v2.2 late-regulator penalty); No investigation: -20%; Hiding breach information: -50%; Similar breach before (poor history): -10%; Inadequate response: -15%;

REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS VARY (REAL-WORLD FLAVOR: THE IN-GAME CLOCK IS GDPR 72H = END OF TURN 8)

GDPR (EU): Notify supervisory authority within 72 hours; fines up to €20M or 4% of global turnover, whichever is HIGHER; (California: Notify without unreasonable delay; CCPA statutory damages fuel class actions; HIPAA: Notification within 60 days (healthcare); Sector-Specific: Finance, healthcare have stricter rules;

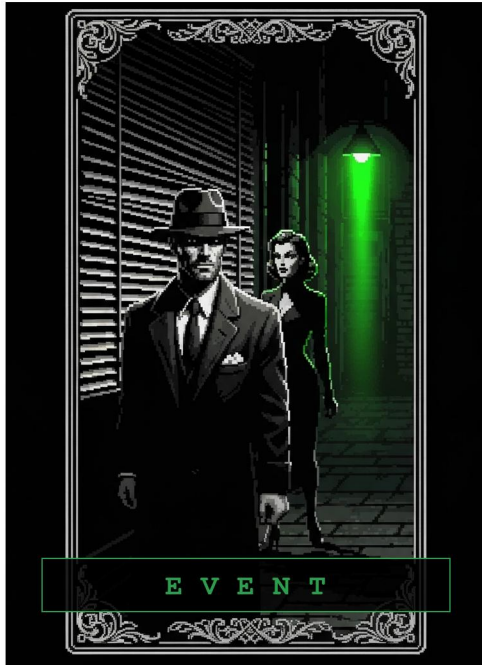
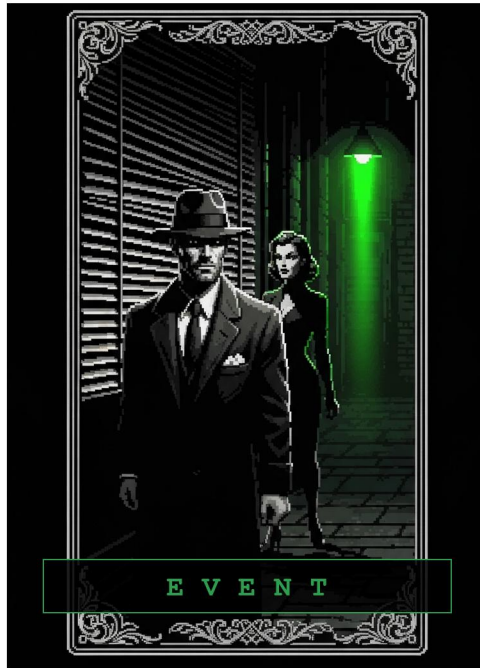
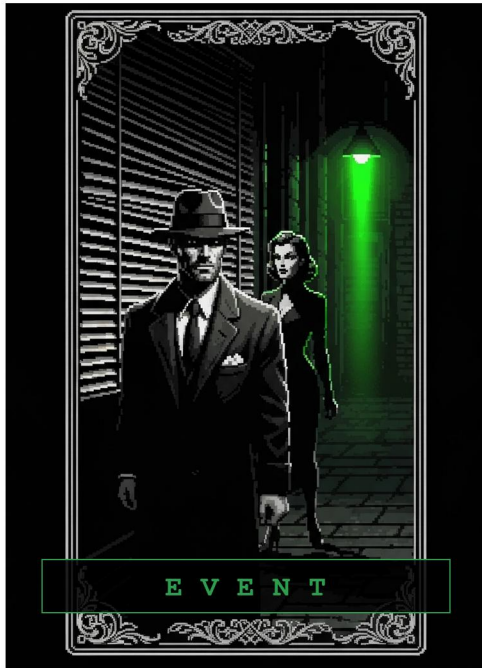
GOAL

Maintain regulatory confidence above 50%; Comply with the Turn-8 notification requirement;

LOSS (V2.2 SINGLE RULE)

Regulator trust at 0% = company collapses (immediate loss); Narrative: crippling fines, executive resignation, license revoked;

INCIDENT ZERO · DISASTER RECOVERY



STAKEHOLDER CARD

STAKE-03

MEDIA / PUBLIC

STAKEHOLDER TYPE: External / Communication

PRIMARY CONCERN: Newsworthy story (bigger = bigger problem)

TRUST METER: Starts at 40% (media is naturally skeptical)

ESCALATION: Escalates based on company response quality

DESCRIPTION

Media outlets, journalists, bloggers, social media. Media decides whether breach is: Small tech story (1 article); Major business news (multiple outlets, days); National news (major outlets, weeks); International scandal (global coverage);

BEHAVIOR

Positive Coverage (70%+): "Company handled breach well", trust maintained; Neutral Coverage (40-70%): Matter-of-fact reporting, some concern; Negative Coverage (<40%): "Company slow to respond", "Cover-up suspected"; Scandal (<20%): Major negative coverage, "Company failed customers";

WHAT AFFECTS MEDIA COVERAGE

Positive Factors:: Proactive media statement (ACTION-11): +20%; Quick notification (customers notified by end of Turn 5): +15%; CEO takes responsibility: +10%; Transparent communication: +10%; Third-party validation: +5%; Negative Factors:: "No comment" response: -30%; Delayed notification (discovered by media): -40%; Executives dodge reporters: -25%; Defensive responses: -20%; Multiple breaches: -30%;

MEDIA IMPACT ON BUSINESS

Positive media = customers stay, suppliers trust company; Negative media = customers leave, stock price drops, suppliers question; Scandal media = business collapse possible, bankruptcy risk;

GOAL

Maintain media trust above 40%; Frame narrative as "company handled responsibly"; Minimize negative coverage (below 20% = CRITICAL warning; triggers EVENT-07);

LOSS (V2.2 SINGLE RULE)

Media trust at 0% = company collapses (immediate loss); Narrative: negligence narrative sticks, stock crash, consumer boycott;

CRISIS ACTIONS THAT HELP

ACTION-11 (Media Management): +20% coverage; ACTION-09 (Customer Notification): +5%(+15%per turn); ACTION-12 (Board Communication): +5% (if credible);

INCIDENT ZERO - DISASTER RECOVERY

STAKEHOLDER CARD

STAKE-04

BOARD OF DIRECTORS

STAKEHOLDER TYPE: Internal / Governance

PRIMARY CONCERN: Company liability and fiduciary duty

TRUST METER: Starts at 70% (board is inherently supportive initially)

ESCALATION: Drops if response is inadequate; may fire CEO

DESCRIPTION

Board of directors (and C-level executives if private company). Board must: Fulfill fiduciary duty to shareholders; Authorize major spending (crisis response can be very expensive); Decide on disclosure (SEC rules if public); Decide on executives' future (fire/retain CEO); Manage shareholder relationships;

BEHAVIOR

High Confidence (70%+): Board is supportive, authorizes spending, defends executives; Medium Confidence (40-70%): Board is questioning, scrutinizes spending, considers changes; Low Confidence (<40%): Board is critical, may fire CEO, considers restructuring; Critical (<20%): Board votes to remove management, sell company, or file bankruptcy;

WHAT AFFECTS BOARD CONFIDENCE

Increases Confidence:: Board Notification (ACTION-12): +20%; Professional incident response: +15%; Quick containment: +10%; Good regulatory relationship: +10%; Transparent communication: +5%; Decreases Confidence:: Lack of incident response plan: -20%; Slow response: -10% per turn; Inadequate budget allocation: -15%; Executive hiding information: -40%; Multiple breaches: -30%;

BOARD DECISION POINTS (V2.2 CLOCK)

Turn 3: Board Meeting (EVENT-04; ACTION-12 should be done before it); Board decides if CEO retains confidence; Major spending approvals (forensics, lawyers, PR); Disclosure decisions; Turn 5: Mid-crisis assessment (EVENT-09 Shareholder Pressure, if public); Shareholder communication; Restructuring discussions; Turn 8: End-game assessment; Board reviews the response as part of final scoring; Long-term damage control; Leadership changes finalized;

GOAL

Maintain board confidence above 50%; Board authorizes necessary spending; Executives retain their positions (below 20% = CRITICAL warning state);

LOSS (V2.2 SINGLE RULE)

Board trust at 0% = company collapses (immediate loss); Narrative: CEO fired, forced sale, bankruptcy filing;

CONTINUED IN MODULE RULES

INCIDENT ZERO - DISASTER RECOVERY

STAKEHOLDER CARD

STAKE-05

EXECUTIVE LEADERSHIP

STAKEHOLDER TYPE: Internal / Management

PRIMARY CONCERN: Job security and company survival

TRUST METER: Starts at 80% (executives are naturally supportive initially)

ESCALATION: Drops if response is chaotic; may resign or sabotage

DESCRIPTION

C-level executives (CEO, CTO, CFO, CISO, General Counsel) who must: Make critical decisions under pressure; Coordinate crisis response; Handle media inquiries; Present to board; Ensure company continues operating; Manage their own careers/reputations;

BEHAVIOR

High Morale (70%+): Executives are focused, coordinated, decisive; Medium Morale (40-70%): Executives are stressed, some disagreements, slower decisions; Low Morale (<40%): Executives may resign, infighting, poor decisions; Critical (<20%): Executive exodus, chaos, no leadership;

WHAT AFFECTS EXECUTIVE MORALE

Increases Morale:: Clear incident response plan: +15%; Professional guidance (consultants): +10%; Regular communication/updates: +5% per turn; Board support: +10%; Progress on containment: +5%; Decreases Morale:: No response plan: -20%; Chaotic response: -10% per turn; Board criticism: -15%; Media attacks: -10%; Regulatory fines: -15%;

EXECUTIVE DEPARTURES RISK

If morale drops too low, key executives resign; Each resignation removes their expertise from future decisions; Replacement executives are less effective initially; Crisis becomes harder to manage;

GOAL

Maintain executive morale above 50%; Prevent key executive resignations (below 30% triggers EVENT-11; below 20% = CRITICAL warning state); While Executive trust is below 30%, the Justification bonus is unavailable (see EVENT-11);

LOSS (V2.2 SINGLE RULE)

Executive trust at 0% = company collapses (immediate loss); Narrative: executive exodus, leadership vacuum, chaos;

CONTINUED IN MODULE RULES

INCIDENT ZERO - DISASTER RECOVERY

